



Tataskweyak Cree Nation

General Delivery, Split Lake, MB R0B 1P0

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The Honourable Mike Moyes
Minister of Environment and Climate Change
Room 344 Legislative Building
450 Broadway
Winnipeg, MB R3C 0V8

The Honourable Adrien Sala
Minister responsible for Manitoba Hydro
Room 103 Legislative building
450 Broadway
Winnipeg, MB R3C 0V8

December 3, 2025

Via email

Dear Minister Moyes and Minister Sala:

Re: Churchill River Diversion - Short Term Extension Licence Request

As Chief of Tataskweyak Cree Nation (TCN), I write on behalf of my Nation, its citizens and *namao* (sturgeon) regarding Manitoba Hydro's request for a five-year Short Term Extension License for the Churchill River Diversion (CRD) project.

For more than four decades, the CRD has had significant negative impacts on our members' ability to exercise our Treaty right to fish for sturgeon on the Lower Churchill River. The CRD has also made it much more difficult for us to fulfil our stewardship obligations and maintain our connection to our culture and way of life. The serious, long-term effects of the CRD project have never been properly considered or addressed by Manitoba or Manitoba Hydro.

TCN is also currently a party to a judicial review before the Manitoba Court of King's Bench, challenging the issuance of the Final Licence for the CRD project on the grounds that the Crown failed to discharge its constitutional duty to consult and accommodate. A decision by Manitoba Hydro to continue and prolong the operation of the CRD as contemplated in the Extension Licence Request would compound the existing breach and result in new and additional negative impacts on our rights and territory.

We expect Manitoba to uphold its obligation to consult with us prior to any decision to extend Manitoba Hydro's licence for the CRD. At minimum, this requires an iterative, good faith process of engagement in which Manitoba seeks to understand and address my Nation's

concerns, as well as providing access to adequate time and resources to enable TCN to participate in all aspects of consultation on an informed basis.

As you may be aware, TCN recently commissioned expert reports regarding the devastating impacts of the CRD and related infrastructure on sturgeon populations. The information set out in these reports should form an integral part of the consultation process, and Manitoba's ultimate decision with respect to the Licence Extension Request.

As the traditional stewards of the land, we must decide our own path going forward, and we believe strongly in the importance of meaningful and in-depth consultation. We also believe that a licensing decision made without such a review and in the absence of evidence and input from TCN would be detrimental to *namao*, as well as contrary to the spirit and intent of our Treaty relationship and the principles of reconciliation.

We trust that Manitoba will act honourably and in strict accordance with its constitutional duties, and we look forward to receiving a response from you regarding the CRD consultation process in a timely manner.

Ekosi,

A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read 'D. Spence', is written over a light blue rectangular background.

Chief Doreen Spence

cc. The Honorable Joanne Thomson, Minister of Fisheries and Oceans Canada